Great Swamp Bonsai Society

有名 泥地 盆栽 社会

Summer, 2005 Newsletter

Next Meeting of GSBS: 7:00 pm Tuesday, July 12th at the Arboretum.

NO MEETING on August 9 but don't forget the Picnic on Aug. 14.

Details in "upcoming events" on page 3

Please note: There will be no newsletter in August.

June Meeting Highlights:

Martin Schmalenberg presented a very informative lecture and demonstration on the art of creating and displaying small plants. The Japanese call this *Kusumono*. Marty brought many examples from his own collection as well as several "raw" items from which to build a display. The example that Marty created was raffled off at the conclusion of his demonstration.

In addition, the remaining trees from the Henry Freud collection were auctioned to the highest bidders. All of the trees were purchased at reasonable prices.

Here are some highlights of the evening.

You've got to get dirty!...

Checking Auction Trees

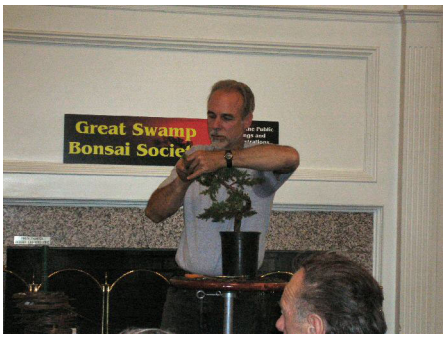
The final product

A fine arrangement

ANNUAL SHOW / OPEN HOUSE

Our annual open house and show was very well attended by both members and the public. The display of trees was terrific and the lecture demos by David Yedwab, John Michalski/Juan Calderone and John Michalski/Doug Siedenberg filled almost all seats. We actually approached "SRO" for the lectures. Two demo trees were raffled and both were won by non-members. We're hoping that many of the people who attended will decide to join Great Swamp in the near future. Many were quite enthusiastic. Thanks go out to John Michalski and to Michael Markoff for the advertising that brought in the public. Thanks to all who participated. It wouldn't have been such a success without you…

Some pictures follow:



I apologize for the quantity and quality of the pictures. Many of them didn't come out at all well. It was a new camera for me at the time and I wasn't quite used to it. (some of the pictures were REALLY bad and you won't get to see those…)

It's possible that Steve Guyette may have taken some pictures, which I'm sure will be of higher quality) and posted them on our web site.

The President's Corner:

Mark Schmuck

Hi again,

Let me begin by thanking everyone who helped make our Open House a great success this year. From the members who helped set up, the members who displayed some really fantastic trees, the demonstrators, the raffle sellers, the tear down crew, I can't thank you enough. A lot of work was made easier because everyone pitched in. Thanks are also due to the members behind the scenes at every club meeting who help make it happen. Steve for our Web site and Dan for one of the best newsletters out there today, and I see lots of club newsletters every month. Lastly thanks to the guys who take it upon themselves to make sure the meeting room is as clean as we found it on meeting night. OK, this is starting to sound like a farewell speech, it's not!

Just two reminders, there are still spots available for our afternoon tropical workshop with George LeBolt of Bergen Bonsai. Bring your own tree 50$ per member July 12 -1-4pm classroom-A, followed by a tropical lecture demo by George, tree will be raffled.

Reminder 2 Be sure to get in touch with Marty if you plan on attending our annual picnic at Stillwater Studio Sunday Aug14 everyone is welcome to attend, eat some foods drink some beers see some awesome trees all in a beautiful woodland setting.

See you next meeting Mark..

July 12 Meeting Agenda: **George LeBolt**

George will be visiting from Bergen Bonsai. He will present a tropical workshop during the afternoon from 1 to 4 pm, after which he will present a lecture demonstration on tropical bonsai at our regular meeting. The member cost for the workshop will be $50.00. George will have some trees available for purchase, too.

There are openings for the workshop and we'd like to encourage you to sign up to attend. Contact Mark at 973.625.4632 to arrange for a seat. This is a "BYOT" workshop so bring your tropicals to work on.

Upcoming Events: **(items marked with a •W denote a workshop)**

August 9: No Meeting

August 14: Sunday. Club Picnic at Stillwater Studio, Stillwater, NJ. There will be an open discussion on the topic; "The state of Bonsai today…" Everyone is encouraged to bring something edible to share with the membership. Marty has requested that everyone participating please contact him regarding what you'd like to bring. He will be coordinating things so that we don't end up with 12 bowls of macaroni salad and only 6 hot-dogs.
Please contact Marty by e-mail at sputnik1950@hotmail.com or by phone 973.383.8377

Stillwater Studio is reached via Route 80 West to Exit 12.
Follow Route 521 North to Route 94.
Turn Left on 94 and proceed to the first Right turn.
Make the sharp Right and continue North on 521. This becomes Stillwater Road.
Continue to follow Stillwater Road (521) until you reach route 617.
Turn Left on 617. Follow 617 for approximately 1.7 miles to Middleville Road.
Turn Right onto Middleville Road. Stillwater Studio is less than 1/4 mile on the left.
Hope to see you there...

•W **September 20**. Third Tuesday. There will be an afternoon workshop with Roy Nagatoshi from California. Members Only, $50 per person. Bring your own tree. Details will be provided. In the evening, Roy will conduct a lecture/demo on an as yet unpicked tree, to be raffled at the conclusion of the meeting. Roy's trees were prominently featured in the Karate Kid films.

NOTE:

Unless otherwise specified, all of the Great Swamp afternoon workshops are held at the Arboretum, in Classroom "A" from 1:00 pm to 4:00 pm., members only, 6 to 8 people, $50 per person, bring your own tree.

And don't forget our website www.arboretumfriends.org/gsbonsai .
Follow the links to the Newsletter.

July/August Plant Care Tips.

For July:

Water, Water, Water. Just don't over-do it. We're into the hot part of the year now and your plants will be getting quite thirsty as the days heat up.

Vigorous growth has slowed but a second surge can be expected. Be sure to keep your watering can handy as pots heat up and dry out quickly.

Wounds tend to heal quickly in the warm weather. It's a good time to prune your pines, but beware of over-pruning deciduous material at this time. It's difficult to see structure trough the leaves and you may be making a mistake. Shari can be created now.

Your Junipers are really active and so should you be with pinching back. You can leaf-prune deciduous material up to mid July. Wiring can be done with abandon., especially conifers.

Continue feeding as in June. Give High Potassium to flowering species.

For August:

Water, water, water, just like July. Maybe, more-so if weather is typical.

Older foliage will begin to look tired, but many trees are still growing. Next year's leaf and flower are already beginning to set.

As with July, wounds will heal quickly but generally best by mid month. Heavy pruning may result in new growth that won't necessarily harden in time for winter. Keep up your Jin and Shari creations.

Trimming should slow considerably except for Junipers which will continue their growth. Stop leaf pruning of deciduous this month.

Wiring of dediduous = Not now, but conifers = Yes, especially Junipers.

Reduce your nitrogen feeding this month, and eliminate it altogether by month's end.

Remove Weeds and "random" shoots. Maintain vigilant pest control. Remove old needles from pine shoots that are read to wire. Stop air-layering by the end of the first week of the month. Too late for defoliation or heavy pruning now since new growth won't harden off by winter.

See you in September...

- Tips taken from *Growing & Displaying Bonsai* by Colin Lewis and Neil Sutherland and from *Bonsai, the Art of Growing and Keeping Miniature Trees* by Peter Chan

Contact Information:

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Ideas and offers of assistance for events, or scheduling questions, can be addressed to any of the officers. Don't be shy. Any and all help would be appreciated.